

Is the noise law to blame?

A European Parliament study, tested against Eurostat and WHO levels

THE CLAIM

“...not the cause of the noise problems in Malta.”

Hjerp and Coffey, study for the EP Petitions Committee, February 2026

On transposition and implementation of the Environmental Noise Directive.

Opinions are the authors', not the Parliament's.

VERDICT

LARGELY SUPPORTED

Law is not the cause; that does not mean Malta is quiet.

SUPPORTED

LARGELY
SUPPORTED

NOT
SUBSTANTIATED

MISLEADING

CONTRADICTED

MAIN RESULTS

Grade C

Study holds together

Two meaningful non-conformities; no END infringement case 2015–2025 (per the study).

31.3%

Highest noise in the EU

People reporting street or neighbour noise, 2023 (EU 18.1%).

55 dB

Thresholds above WHO

END reporting threshold 55 dB; WHO road level 53 dB, aircraft 45 dB.

Outside

Complaints mostly outside END

Per the study, most complaints concern construction, entertainment and neighbourhood noise, outside the Directive.

2025

Action plan late

Plan due January 2025 not published by January 2026.

FAIR TO SAY

Malta has had no END infringement case in 2015–2025, per the study. We did not re-check the law, and the 21% vs 9% survey figure has no identified source.

WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT

☐ The survey behind the 21% vs 9% figure.

☐ Complaint data on construction and entertainment noise.

☐ Date of the next Action Plan.

☐ Legal check of the transposition table.